

Bob Ingram

'As I Was Saying ...'

TL Is Spry Octogenarian

SATURDAY'S BASE TOUCHING. The 82-year-old Texas League is showing no signs of senility. It went out in bad weather last night and had two 2-1 games, a 2-0 shutout and a 7-6 contest that went 12 innings. How are those for openers? Signs of progress: The names of the Albuquerque players are sewn on the backs of their playing shirts. Old Blue was there and Memphis won its opener, beating Arkansas 7-6. Old Blue is a dog who adopted the Blues or they adopted him late last season. With him as their mascot, the Blues beat Amarillo three straight to win the league title. He was lost recently. They found him behind bars at the animal pound. He was returned just in time to help the Blues open the season. Mary Huana after hearing that a gallery gave a golfer a standing ovation said she wonders if it wouldn't be a bigger honor to any golfer if the gallery gave him a sitting ovation since the members were standing to begin with. Colorful sports language: Roulette eyes. In the words of another slang expression, it pertains to an athlete who has his bell rung. Or has been cracked on the head and is a bit dizzy or wobbly. Did you hear of the man who wouldn't drink to Excess but drank to nearly everybody else?

Death Strikes Suddenly

BARRY PENNINGTON, outstanding center at U.T. El Paso in the late 1930s, died like Brooks Dawson did — suddenly and unexpectedly. Pennington was an all-Border conference center in the Mack Saxon-Harry Phillips regime and, as one of his teammates, Ken Heineman, points out, he was just as outstanding as the team's big linebacker in an era when players went both ways. Paul Doyle, the little left hander who was on the Sun Kings pitching staff for three years and is now with the California Angels, is noted for his move to first base. He's picked off 200 runners in his career, 37 in one season. That throw to first is called his third pitch. What they're doing now: George Oaks, 220-pound defensive end from El Paso, is on the New Mexico varsity football squad now holding spring practice. It's good news that Bob Redman, auditor of the Sun Kings, is recovering from a heart attack. Billy Casper has a nephew, Vergil A. Casper, who runs the Casper Roofing Co., in Albuquerque. An Arizona writer called it "beautiful Dudley Field" and said it was better suited for rodeo than baseball. Week's quote of note from Rocky Bridges, the good humor man who is a coach of the California Angels and formerly managed the Sun Kings, after pitching batting practice to the Angels recently: "The trouble with me is that I'm sneaky slow."

Two Marathoning El Pasoans

PARDON THIS late reporting. Two El Pasoans ran in the Fourth Annual College of Artesia 26-mile Marathon in which the New Mexico town became the foot blister capital of the world. The two El Pasoans were Sydney Dictor, who admits to "being over 40," and who finished a very creditable fourth, an improvement over his 1968 race in which he was 18th. Norman Pittenger, the other El Pasoan, finished 36th, running a good



EL PASO MARATHONERS — Norman Pittenger, left, and Sydney Dictor, both of El Paso, are shown running shoulder to shoulder in the Artesia Marathon. Dictor was fourth, Pittenger 36th.

race considering he had never gone beyond 10 miles in running competition before.

The race drew 349 participants. It included high school and college athletes and a few who like Dictor and Pittenger were in the older category. The winner was Bill Blewett, 22, senior at U. of Oklahoma and a former captain of the Sooner track team. His time was 2 hours, 51 minutes, 25 seconds. Dictor came in at 3:14:49. Many others struggled in hours later. Anyone who finished that race was a "winner."

Pay'll Be Good for 'Skate'

INSIDE INFORMATION on Nate Archibald's salary with the Cincinnati Royals is that he'll make \$45,000 his first year, \$55,000 the second year and \$65,000 the third year. There'll also be money for him from investments made by the club. With this kind of financial outlook, the Skate shouldn't be skating on thin ice in the future if ever. He'll be able to support his wife and four children in good style. He has three children now and another one is expected. Jack Resen, promotional director of Bassett Center, was in Hawaii when Nate was wooing the fans in the Aloha tournament. He wasn't able to see the games but met a woman tourist from South Africa who did go to the games. It was her first look at basketball. She told Resen: "I had a bad opinion of Texas on account of the Kennedy assassination. But after seeing Archibald play, I think Texas is a great state." A 11 a.m., Sun Bowl game on Dec. 18. I don't know whether the press box will serve breakfast or lunch. Let's win the Sunshine Trophy tomorrow. It's given to the city that has the bigger opening day attendance in competition between Albuquerque and El Paso. The Dodgers drew 3,008 last night. To beat it El Paso needs 2,009 tomorrow afternoon at Dudley Field. Is 13 lucky or unlucky? It's still a standoff after Apollo 13's jinx but a fine trip ending. Come on out and let's hear it for the Kings tomorrow.

WAY TO PITCH AT 'CAPE' OR DUDLEY FIELD

If the pitcher pitches high,
Wave the old baseball bye, bye.
If the pitcher pitches low,
Batter is out on easy throw.